

just what it can do for you but how it serves you and the people you care about.

Think about why you started this book. You may have wanted to save money so you can pay off debt or catch up on retirement. Maybe you wanted to be able to stick to a budget that, on paper or app, should be doable. Or because you don't care about getting rich, you just want to enjoy your life without going broke. You keep reading stories on the internet and social media about people who've achieved the goals you want and live the life you're striving for. But somehow the knowledge that it's possible is never enough to keep you going.

Being inspired by others' stories is beautiful, but it's external motivation. It won't give you the internal motivation required to make difficult changes. Believe the difficult changes are worth making. Believe in it enough to devote the time it takes to fall in love with the journey. Because when you love the journey in all its successes, frustrations, benefits, challenges, and impact, then you stop thinking of values-based spending as a means to an end and start embracing it as the journey to getting what you love most. Also like gardening, spending is a skill, and you can learn that skill and get better and better at it over time.

Your Turn

Life is about more than money, but money touches everything in life that's important to us. That's why every positive change you make with your spending directly correlates with getting more out of life. The concepts you've learned in this book will eventually transcend spending money and help you spend all your resources better. And before you know it, you'll be frugal.

We started the book acknowledging that frugality is not typically seen as a fun lifestyle. It brings up pictures of a childhood full of frumpy hand-me-downs, dads yelling about the thermostat, and grandmas rinsing plastic bags. Very eco-friendly but not very fun. And yes, when taken to extremes, it's pretty boring. But in its purest form, it is the solution to the challenges most important to us. And we are obsessed with it.

To us, frugality isn't just about spending money well, it's about spending all your resources well: money, time, physical space, natural resources,